

The SAM.gov Registration Guide

SAM.gov registration is free and required before you can bid on anything federal — but it's also where most first-time registrants get stuck or delayed. This guide walks the exact sequence, in order, so you don't lose weeks to a mismatched address.

1

Gather your documents before you start

EIN confirmation letter, your legal business name exactly as filed with the IRS, your business address (must match your state registration and bank exactly), and routing/account numbers for the bank account you'll use for government payment.

2

Create a Login.gov account

SAM.gov requires Login.gov for identity verification. Use the email address you'll check daily — all SAM.gov correspondence and renewal reminders route through it.

3

Start your registration at SAM.gov

Go to sam.gov, sign in, and select "Register Entity." Choose the entity type that matches your actual legal structure (sole proprietor, LLC, corporation, etc.).

4

Get your Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)

SAM.gov assigns your UEI automatically during registration — this replaced the old DUNS number system. Write it down; you'll use it on every capabilities statement and proposal you submit.

5

Add every NAICS code that honestly applies

You can register multiple NAICS codes. Each one opens different solicitations to you — don't register one and assume you're done.

6

Complete your Reps & Certs

Representations and Certifications — a set of standard disclosures (size status, ownership, compliance history). Answer accurately; these are signed legal representations.

7

Submit and wait for validation

Validation typically takes a few days to several weeks. The #1 cause of delay is a mismatch between your legal name/address across the IRS, your state business registry, and your bank — triple-check all three match exactly before submitting.

8

Confirm "Active" status before you bid

Your registration isn't useful until it shows Active. Check your entity dashboard, and calendar your renewal date — registrations expire annually and lapse silently if you forget.

Most common pitfalls

- Business name or address doesn't match exactly across IRS, state registry, and bank.
- EIN entered with a typo — verify against your actual IRS confirmation letter, not memory.
- Forgetting to add a NAICS code you'll need later — you can add more anytime, but it delays eligibility for that opportunity until validated.
- Letting registration lapse — renew before the expiration date, not after.

This guide is free, no strings attached. Once you're Active, head into WARDOG inside FASS Flow — it's already waiting to match live opportunities to your NAICS codes. Questions: admin@fass.systems · flow.fass.systems